

GUIDELINE

Laundering Procedure for Fire Retardant (FR) Coveralls with High-Visibility Stripes

1. Purpose

This procedure provides guidelines for the proper laundering of fire retardant (FR) coveralls with high-visibility stripes to ensure that both the FR properties and the high-visibility features are maintained and meet safety standards.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all personnel responsible for the laundering, maintenance, and inspection of FR coveralls with high-visibility stripes at Silverpoint Energy Services Inc.

3. General Guidelines

- Always follow the manufacturer's care instructions provided on the garment label to maintain the integrity of the FR treatment and reflective stripes.
- Do not dry-clean unless the manufacturer specifically allows it. Some FR materials may degrade from dry-cleaning chemicals.
- Ensure coveralls are cleaned regularly to prevent the buildup of dirt, oils, and chemicals, which can reduce the effectiveness of the FR material and the visibility of the reflective stripes.

4. Laundering Procedure

4.1 Pre-Wash Inspection

- Inspect coveralls for damage such as tears, punctures, or abrasions. If damage is found, repair or remove the coveralls from service before laundering.
- Check for any heavy contamination (e.g., oils, grease, chemicals) that may require special treatment or pre-soaking.
- Special Treatment can be the use of High-Pressure Hot Water to remove heavy debris and oils.

4.2 Washing Instructions

- Water Temperature: Use warm water (max 60°C or 140°F). Hot water can degrade both the FR treatment and the reflective strips over time.
- Detergent: Use a mild, liquid detergent. Avoid using harsh chemicals, bleach, fabric softeners, or starch, as these can impair the FR properties and diminish the reflective properties of the high-visibility stripes.
- Washing Cycle: Use a gentle or normal cycle. Heavy-duty cycles may damage the reflective stripes or wear down the FR fabric faster.
- Load Size: Wash separately from regular clothing to avoid contamination by non-FR fabrics or reflective materials.
- Rinsing: Use multiple rinses if needed, especially for heavily soiled garments. Ensure no detergent residue remains on the fabric.

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4.3 Drying Instructions

- Drying Temperature: Tumble dry on low heat or air dry. High temperatures can reduce the effectiveness of the FR treatment and damage the reflective stripes.
- Avoid Over drying: Remove garments promptly from the dryer to prevent overheating and damage to the FR properties and high-visibility stripes.
- Line Drying: If possible, air-drying is recommended to extend the lifespan of the FR treatment and reflective materials.

5. Maintenance of High-Visibility Stripes

- Inspect reflective stripes after each wash for fading, cracking, or peeling. If the stripes are damaged or no longer reflective, the coveralls must be repaired or replaced.
- Avoid ironing directly over high-visibility reflective strips, as this can melt or damage them.

6. Stain Removal

- For oils and grease: Pre-treat with a mild, enzyme-based cleaner. Avoid solvent-based cleaners, as they may damage the FR coating.
- Do not use bleach or any chlorine-based products, as these can deteriorate both the FR properties and the high-visibility stripes.

7. Post-Wash Inspection

- After laundering, inspect coveralls to ensure they are clean, the FR properties have not been compromised, and the reflective stripes are intact.
- Check for any residual contaminants or damage to the fabric, and if necessary, re-laundry or remove from service if issues are found.

8. Out-of-Service Criteria

Remove FR coveralls with high-visibility stripes from service if:

- The FR protection has been compromised (e.g., excessive wear, thinning fabric).
- The reflective stripes are damaged, no longer reflective, or have begun to peel or crack.
- The coveralls cannot be cleaned properly due to persistent stains, oil, or chemical contamination.

9. Record Keeping

- Maintain laundering logs to track how often FR coveralls are washed, inspected, and when they need repair or replacement.
- Document any incidents of coveralls being removed from service due to damage or loss of protective qualities.

10. Conclusion

By following this laundering procedure, the integrity of the fire-retardant properties and the effectiveness of high-visibility stripes will be preserved, ensuring that workers remain safe while wearing compliant PPE.